

SPACEPORTHOUSTONEDIT

Well, space travel is one of my passions, having watched the moon landing live on grainy black and white TV back in 1969. I caught up with one of the experts from Cape Canaveral launch facility recently. Travel radio Australia and television at the World Travel Market in London and we're here with Philip Britton at the Kennedy Space Center in Florida, United States and Philip, welcome to the program.

Thank you, Geoff. It's great to be here. And tell us a bit about the complex.

It's a fantastic thing and a lot of people don't realize they can actually visit the center and have a great time. Absolutely. Wonderful place, Geoff.

Kennedy Space Center is where man went to the moon from. We put 12 astronauts on the moon from Kennedy, still a working launch facility. You've all got mobile phones, satellites go into space, a lot of them go from Kennedy Space Center.

We've got an Apollo Saturn V rocket at Kennedy, the largest rocket ever built, the vehicle that took 12 men to the moon. Loads to see and do at Kennedy. You can have lunch with an astronaut, you can walk through the rocket garden, you can see the two biggest IMAX screens in the world at Kennedy and it's only a 50 minute drive from Orlando.

It's a great place to be. Now, tell me some of your favorite little bits, you know, that you are really must sees for people who are visiting. The must sees.

We have one of the space shuttles, Space Shuttle Atlantis. Atlantis did 33 missions, Geoff, 33 missions into space, traveled more than 25 million miles around the globe and Atlantis is on permanent display at the Visitor Complex. It's at an angle as if it's flying through space.

You can look through the payload bay doors into the hold, see where a lot of the satellites were launched into space from on the robotic arm and it's a great thing to see and do. Well, I believe you can actually see the cockpit as well. Can people get a tour of that part of it and see inside where the astronauts actually sat? I'd love to say yes, Geoff, but no.

That's strictly off limits, like a fair bit of NASA. Yes, I can imagine and just the sheer scale of everything, it just must be mind blowing. Huge, absolutely.

The complex is over 200 square miles, so it is a relatively big area, big piece of land, but you would expect that when you're launching rockets into space. It does come with a lot of, you know, you've got to do everything safely, but the water's great. It's a nature reserve as well.

We have crocodiles, we have the American bald eagle, so yeah, it's a huge nature reserve as well out on the Canaveral Peninsula. Wonderful. How can people find out more, Philip, about the Kennedy Space Center online? As ever, the World Wide Web, kennedyspacecenter.com, but

Kennedy's a global name, a global brand, so you know, very easy to find out and we'd love to see you there one day.

Thank you very much, Philip, for being on the program. Thanks very much, Geoff. Appreciate it.

See you guys.